accused the CIA of being arrogant and irresponsible for abandoning the two nuclear-powered devices without bothering to inform the government of India. Mr Kohn also alleged that Indian intelligence, which he again wrongly named as the CBI, as well as the Government of India, had been tricked by the CIA. He added that the Indian agency had supplied porters, transport facilities, etc., to the CIA team but alleged that the Indian officials (CBI officials as he called them) were double agents.

Who were these double agents? Perhaps no one knows because at that time, the R&AW was not in existence and the IB was India's primary intelligence organisation. Howard Kohn claimed that from the beginning the CIA took a very arrogant position towards India, did not inform the Gandhi government and tricked the Indian intelligence agency into going along with the project using double agents: CIA agents who were on the Indian payroll.

In the same breath, Kohn claimed that some IB officers were working as double agents for CIA and also that some CIA officers were on the payroll of the IB. If the claim was true then it was clear that the IB had recruited some CIA officers and Operation HAT was the brainchild of the Indian intelligence agency. But the question remains: who was the real puppeteer? The IB or the CIA?

The ME A was livid at the explosive news report and even angrier when Calling Attention notices were served by Member of Parliament Dalpat Singh Paraste and four others on 17 April 1978. Foreign secretary J.S. Mehta called on the US Ambassador to India, Robert F. Goheen, and told him that the issue was